Cultural & Social Factors

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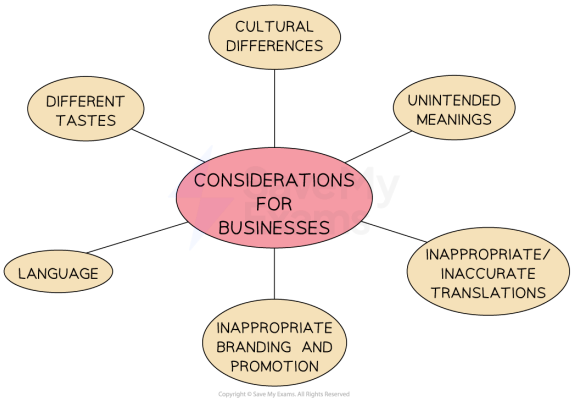
Factors to consider in global marketing

- Global businesses must consider various **cultural and social factors** to effectively market their products/services in different countries and regions

Cultural and social considerations



Cultural and social factors to consider in global markets include language differences and different tastes

- By understanding cultural differences, adapting to local tastes, using accurate translations and avoiding inappropriate branding and promotion, businesses can build strong relationships with their global customers and **achieve long-term success**

Explanation of cultural and social factors

Factor	Explanation
Cultural differences	• Businesses must be aware of how businesses and customers interact in new global markets • Businesses need to understand cultural differences in areas such as values, beliefs, customs and traditions and **adapt their marketing strategies** accordingly

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	Businesses must ensure that their products and services are adapted to meet local preferences
Language	• Businesses must ensure that their marketing messages are **translated accurately and appropriately** • This involves understanding **language nuances** and **idioms** ○ E.g. when KFC entered the Chinese market, it translated its slogan "Finger-Lickin' Good" into Chinese as "Eat Your Fingers Off", which had negative connotations in the Chinese culture
Unintended meanings	• Unintended meanings can arise when businesses use images, symbols or language that have **different connotations** in different cultures ○ E.g. the colour white symbolises purity and innocence in Western cultures, but it represents death and mourning in some Asian cultures
Inappropriate or inaccurate translations	• Inappropriate or inaccurate translations can lead to serious consequences for businesses, including loss of credibility, legal implications and **damage to brand reputation** • Businesses must use **professional translation services** and consult with **local experts** to ensure that their messages are accurately translated and culturally appropriate
Inappropriate branding or promotion	• Inappropriate branding and promotion can occur when businesses use images, symbols or language that are **offensive or inappropriate in different cultures** ○ E.g. in 2018, a Dolce & Gabbana advert showed a Chinese model attempting and failing to eat various Italian dishes with chopsticks. People were outraged over the depiction of Chinese people as lacking refinement and an understanding of culture

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